New York University
History of Cinematography
Fall 2017

H56.1206, 3 Credits
Wednesday 11am-1:45pm

Michael Carmine (212) 998-1489 Office #1120, CinemaDP@aol.com
Prerequisite: Completed 18 credits

This course deals with the history of cinematographic art and science. Relating the working cinematographer's perspective that is unique and factual to a theoretical discussion. Cinematography has a strong tradition of innovation in storytelling with techniques and equipment that have been created to improve image quality.

Week 1 What is Cinematography?
9/6 Building a Visual World
The Frame and Composition
Light and Color
The Lens and Perspective
Camera movement and movement within the frame
Films: "Barry Lyndon"
"Seven"
"A Midnight's Summer Dream"
"Cinematography Style"

Week 2 German Expressionism
9/13 Lighting becomes distinctive, Orthochromatic Film and Mercury lights
Fritz Arno Wagner, Eugen Schufftan, Karl Strauss
Films: "Metropolis"

Wide lens, faster film, Unmotivated and Motivated lighting styles
Greg Toland, George Barnes
Films: "Grapes of Wrath", "Rebecca"

Technicolor/Early Color
3 color Dye transfer process, Color and high-key lighting style
Ray Rennahan, Natalie Kalmus
Films: "Blood and Sand", "Rope", "An American in Paris"

Week 3 Film Noir
9/20 Deconstructing Graduated Tonality, Negative Space
John Alston
Films: "He Walked By Night"
"Blade Runner"
"LA Confidential
"Double Indemnity"
"M"

Week 4 — Anamorphic Lens and the Wide Screen
9/27 — Cinemascope, Vista-Vision, Panavision Camera 65
Freddie Young, Franz Planer
Films: "The Good, The Bad, The Ugly"
"East Of Eden"
"Laurence of Arabia"
"Ben-Hur"

Week 5 — New York Style and Realism
10/4 — Available light and color
Gordon Willis, Nestor Almendros
Films: "Days of Heaven"
"Manhattan"
"Crash"
"Warriors"

Week 6 — Shoot-out: Conrad Hall verse Vittorio Storaro
10/11 — Realism lighting verses Painting with light
Films: "Apocalypse Now"
"The Last Emperor"
"The Road to Perdition"
"American Beauty"

Week 7 — Chemical and Lab Processes, In camera effects
10/18 — Flashing, Bleach By-Pass, Double Printing
Caleb Deschanel, Darius Khondji
Films: "Three Kings"
"The Natural"
"Delicatessen"
"The Fountain"

Week 8 — Stabilized Cameras — ABSTRACT DUE
10/25 — Garret Brown, Haskell Wexler
Films: "Bound for Glory"
"Step Into Liquid"
"Russian Ark"
"Birdman"

Week 9 — The First Quality HD Cinema
11/1 — The Digital Intermediate, Kodak Spirit and Arri Laser
Roger Deakins, Dean Semler
Films: "O Brother"
"Collateral"
"Apocalypto"
"Earth"

Week 10 — Woman Cinematographers in a Patriarch System
11/8 — Reed Morano, Rachel Morrison, Mandy Walker
Films: "Frozen River"
"Fruitvale Station"
"Jane Got a Gun"
"Vinyl"

Week 11 Painting with Light 2.0, In-Camera Effects
11/15 B. Delbonnel, J. Kaminski
Films: "Amelie"
"Saving Private Ryan"
"Illusionist"
"Memento"

Week 12 Current working treads Plus High Speed
11/29 Films: "Girl with a Dragon Tattoo"
"Pride and Prejudice"
"City of God"
"Sherlock Holmes" Forrest Scene

Week 13 Other important visual trends
12/6 Films: "Fallen Angels"
"Baraka"
"The Fall"
"Pans Labyrinth"

Assignments:

1) Midterm Abstract Paper **DUE ON OCTOBER 25, 2017**

Write a 300-word abstract of your final paper. Your abstract is not a blog! This abstract/treatment must be detailed in your investigation of the issues and points you will either prove or disprove in your final paper. Remember this paper must be on a Cinematography Topic! Directing topics will not be considered and rejected. You will submit this paper to my cinemadp@aol.com e-mail as a WORD document only so I can add comments electronically. NO WORD DOCUMENT - NO COMMENTS NO GRADE.

2) **Final Paper Choices – No electronic files – Only Submit Hard Copy Paper!!**

a) Write at least a 2000-word essay on a cinematographic technique or technology. Include the history of the problem that it solved and how it was used effectively and/or ineffectively. Also, explain how it has been used to advance the art of cinematography.

OR

b) Write at least a 2000-word essay on one Cinematographer and explain his/her aesthetic style and how it works from movie to movie or how the artist developed his/her visual style.

Attendance and Participation 20%, Midterm Abstract Paper 30%, Final Paper 50%
Your Midterm grade will be based on your Abstract Paper and your attendance and participation.

Suggested Cinematography Research Books in print:

The Art of Cinematography, Bob Fisher, 2014
Hollywood Lighting from the Silent Era to Film Noir, Patrick Keating, 2010
The Art of the Cinematographer, Leonard Maltin, Dover, 1978
New Cinematographers, Alexander Ballinger, Collins/Design, 2004
Masters of Light, Schaefer and Salvato, University of California Press, 1984
Writer of Light, edited by Ray Zone, ASC Press 2000
Making Pictures: A Century of European Cinematography, Abrams Publishing, 2003
Who' Who of Victorian Cinema, edited by Herbert and McKernan, BFI Publishing, 1996